THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

MWM PMWM7020 Family Office

GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructor: Prof. Eric Poon and Chris Ng

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Consultation times: TBD
Tutor: TBD
Course Website: Moodle
Reference Book:TBD

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course provides an in-depth examination of family offices as sophisticated organizations managing multi-generational wealth. Students explore governance structures, investment strategy, risk management, succession planning, philanthropy, and family dynamics. Emphasis is placed on aligning financial objectives with family values, managing complex stakeholder relationships, and navigating regulatory and cross-border considerations. Through case studies and practitioner perspectives, participants develop practical insights into designing, operating, and advising single- and multi-family offices in a global context.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

1. Understand and evaluate family office models
2. Design integrated wealth and investment strategies
3. Manage family governance and succession challenges
4. Navigate regulatory and cross-border complexities
5. Advise and operate family offices professionally

PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

PLO1: Acquisition of the techniques and advanced knowledge in the interdisciplinary fields of wealth management including but not limited to financial services, technology and law: Students should acquire techniques and advanced knowledge in the interdisciplinary fields of wealth management including but not limited to financial services, technology and law.

PLO2: Application and integration of interdisciplinary knowledge and skills to identify and tackle practical problems, and design innovative products and systems with international standards and global vision: Students should be able to apply and integrate interdisciplinary knowledge and skills in the fields of wealth management to identify and tackle problems, and design innovative products and systems with international standards and global vision.

PLO3: Inculcating leadership, professional ethics and competence in the interdisciplinary fields of wealth management: Students should demonstrate the capacity to recognise, understand and develop appropriate options in ethical and social issues in the interdisciplinary fields of investment and wealth management. In their learning experiences, they will be working in teams that promote leadership training and development of leadership traits. In addition, they are to adhere to and respect university regulations on academic conduct.

PLO4: Mastering communication skills: Students should be able to articulate in public and be able to make convincing and coherent presentations, write effectively and use specific technical terminology in the interdisciplinary fields of wealth management in contemporary presentation tools context.

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Course Learning Outcomes	Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes

CLO1: Analyze single- and multi-family office structures, governance frameworks, and operating models to assess their suitability for different family needs and stages.	PLO1
CLO2: Apply principles of strategic asset allocation, risk management, and capital preservation aligned with long-term, multi-generational objectives.	PLO1, 2
CLO3: Develop approaches to family governance, succession planning, and next-generation engagement that balance financial discipline with family dynamics and values.	PLO3, 4
CLO4: Identify key legal, tax, and regulatory considerations affecting family offices across jurisdictions and incorporate them into decision-making.	PLO1, 2
CLO5. - Build practical skills to advise families or manage a family office, integrating fiduciary responsibility, ethics, and stakeholder communication..	PLO3, 4

COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Course Teaching and Learning Activities	**Expected Hour**	**Study Load (% of study)**
T&L1. Lecture with interactive presentation	36	30%
T&L2. Tutorial and e-forum discussions	12	10%
T&L3. Case-based study and analysis	30	25%
T&L4. Self study	42	35%
Total	120	100%

Assessment Methods	**Brief Description (Optional)**	**Weight**	**Aligned Course Learning Outcomes**
A1. Written assignments	Two short essays to explain the model and, concepts, and discuss trends	40%	CLO1, CLO2. CLO4
A2. Group project & presentation	Case study to do analysis and synthesis of the chosen study field, or family office investment presentation (role play)	40%	CLO1, CLO2, CLO5
A3. Class participation	Participation in e-forum to discuss a specific topic for clarifying understanding of the concept	20%	CLO1, CLO3
	Total	100%	

STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT

Course Grade Descriptors

A+, A, A-	• Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions professionally • High participation in discussions • Present arguments that have an element of originality • Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the exams with very accurate computation and very good analytical and problem solving skills • Excellent performance in assignments

B+, B, B-	• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions in a logical way • Good participation in discussions • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Achieve a standard of good performance in the exams with accurate computation and good analytical and problem solving skills • Good performance in assignments
C+, C, C-	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Fairly address questions as set • Some participation in discussions • Present arguments in a well-structure manner • Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the exams with reasonably accurate computation and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills • Acceptable performance in assignments
D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Barely address questions as set • Minimal or no participation in discussions • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the exams with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills • Marginally acceptable performance in assignments
F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Unable or unwilling to handle questions • Minimal or no participation in discussions • Present arguments poorly • Fail to meet a standard of passing the exams with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills • Poorly performance in assignments
Assessment Rubrics for Participation	
A+, A, A-	• High participation in discussions • Always attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions professionally • Present arguments that have an element of originality • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
B+, B, B-	• Good participation in discussions • Often attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions in a logical way • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
C+, C, C-	• Some participation in discussions • Sometimes attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Fairly address questions as set • Present arguments in a well-structure manner • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
D+, D	• Minimal or no participation in discussions • Rarely attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Barely address questions as set • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
F	• Minimal or no participation in discussions • Almost never attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Unable or unwilling to handle questions • Present arguments poorly • Behave poorly in class (often chatting with others, using cell phones, or being late)

Assessment Rubrics for Assignments and the Exam	
A+, A, A-	• Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Present arguments that have an element of originality • Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the assessments with very accurate computation and very good analytical and problem solving skills
B+, B, B-	• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Achieve a standard of good performance in the assessments with accurate computation and good analytical and problem solving skills
C+, C, C-	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments in a well-structure manner • Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the assessments with reasonably accurate computation and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills
D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the assessments with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills
F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments poorly • Fail to meet a standard of passing the assessments with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

This will include a schedule of topics, readings, continuous assessment and other activities for each week during the course.

REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS (e.g. journals, textbooks, website addresses etc.)

To be announced on Moodle.

MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

○ Online response via Moodle site

○ Others: ___SFTL_____ (please specify)

COURSE POLICY (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)

A student's academic responsibility, such as issues of plagiarism is often highlighted in a course outline and other academic issues or procedures which may be pertinent to a specific program or course. Other policies including academic honesty, attendance etc. could also be included as appropriate.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION (e.g. e-learning platforms & materials, penalty for late assignments, etc.)

Assignments will be submitted in class before the lectures. No late assignment will be accepted.
Lecture notes and self-learning materials will be uploaded on Moodle.
Good questions and discussions on Moodle will be awarded participation grades.